# Cartworth: your launch checklist

Only the things that need you. Everything else, Claude is doing. Updated September 24, 2026.

**Where things stand. cartworth.app is live** (the marketing site, with support@ and hello@ forwarding to your Gmail, and the sitemap in Google and Bing). The price check across Chicago, Lombard, Milwaukee and Kenosha found three wrong "best price" headlines, all fixed and re-checked: 0 wrong in 56. 456 web tests pass, including 13 browser tests. The prices are **not ship-ready yet** for two reasons that need your Mac: the iPhone half of every fix has not been compiled or tested, and the check could not cover every store from the cloud (Instacart rate-limited it, and Trader Joe's blocks cloud machines). Everything not on this list, Claude is handling.

## 1. Start now: these take the longest

Each one blocks something later. Do them first even though they are not exciting.

- [ ] **Decide on the price-data question, ideally with a lawyer** — Biggest risk to launch

  Cartworth reads prices from Instacart, Flipp, Whole Foods, Trader Joe's and ALDI without an agreement. For a paid app, Apple guideline 5.2.2 requires permission to use a third-party service's content, and it is your biggest legal exposure. It is also a capacity question now: Instacart rate-limited the price check after about 2,500 requests in 90 minutes from one machine, even at one request every 0.7 s, so a public web app that sends every visitor through one server would hit that quickly. Read their terms of use, then get advice before charging money.

- [ ] **Enroll in the Apple Developer Program as an individual** — $99 a year, 1 to 2 days

  developer.apple.com/programs/enroll. Your name (Nicholas Soderstrom) shows as the seller. Showing "Cartworth" instead needs an LLC and a D-U-N-S number, which takes weeks.

- [ ] **Activate the Paid Apps Agreement, banking and tax** — 30 minutes plus Apple review

  App Store Connect, then Business (Agreements, Tax, and Banking). Accept the Paid Apps Agreement, add your bank account and the W-9. Until this is active, in-app purchases cannot be tested at all, even in the sandbox.

- [ ] **Search the trademark "Cartworth"** — 1 hour or ~$500 with a lawyer

  tmsearch.uspto.gov, especially classes 9 (software), 35 (price comparison) and 42 (online services). The agents were blocked by the site's firewall, so this has never actually been checked. A trademark attorney's search is cheap insurance.

## 2. This week: on your Mac

These need the Mac: the cloud has no iOS Simulator, and store sites treat it differently.

- [ ] **Run the iOS tests** — 15 minutes

  Open ios/Cartworth.xcodeproj in Xcode and press Cmd+U (or have Claude run it on the Mac). Every pricing fix of this round was ported to Swift but has never been compiled: the store catalog, request pacing, matching, the "8oz, 9ct" rule and the per-pound check.

- [ ] **Run the price check from home, one ZIP at a time** — ~15 min per ZIP

  node scripts/price-audit.js --zips 60148 (then 53211, then 53142), with a break between. It covers the stores the cloud run lost to Instacart's rate limit, and shows whether Trader Joe's answers a home connection: it refused every search from the cloud (HTTP 403).

- [ ] **Review and merge the fix-round-3 branch** — 10 minutes
  On GitHub, open a pull request from fix-round-3 into main (or ask Claude to), look it over and merge. The live site already has its part; the app fixes are only on the branch.

- [ ] **Get free Kroger developer keys** — Free, 20 minutes
  developer.kroger.com: create an account, register an application, and copy its client ID and secret into Cartworth's Settings. This gives real shelf and card prices for Mariano's and Pick 'n Save instead of their Instacart listings, which run above the shelf. Read the API terms while you are there.

- [ ] **Send a test email to support@cartworth.app** — 2 minutes
  Routing is set up; confirm it lands in your Gmail. App Review writes to it.

## 3. Social media

A full plan with verified draft posts is being written now. Your part:

- [ ] **Claim the handles** — 30 minutes
  Create the accounts on the platforms the plan recommends, and claim "cartworth" everywhere else even if you never post there. Claude cannot create accounts for you.

- [ ] **Decide how you want to show up** — A decision
  On camera or not (it changes which platforms make sense), and how many hours a week you can realistically give it.

## 4. App Store submission

After Apple enrollment (section 1) and after the price check passes.

- [ ] **Re-shoot the price screenshots on the fixed build** — 1 hour
  The captured search, deal and trip screens predate this round and show errors since fixed (a $29.84/gal milk, peanut butter as butter). Claude can drive the simulator on the Mac; the script that frames them for the site is site/tools/make-device-shots.py.

- [ ] **Sign in to Xcode with your Apple ID** — 5 minutes
  Xcode, Settings, Accounts. This lets builds be signed and uploaded to TestFlight.

- [ ] **Create the app record in App Store Connect** — 30 minutes
  Name Cartworth, bundle ID app.cartworth.ios. Claude drafts the description, keywords, privacy answers, age rating and review notes for you to paste in.

- [ ] **Create the three purchase options, with these exact IDs** — 45 minutes
  app.cartworth.ios.pro.monthly ($3.99), app.cartworth.ios.pro.yearly ($19.99), both in one subscription group; and app.cartworth.ios.pro.lifetime ($29.99, one-time purchase). They must match the app exactly.

- [ ] **Install from TestFlight and make a sandbox purchase on your own iPhone** — 1 hour
  The first time a real purchase is tried end to end. Also try it on an iPad if you can borrow one.

- [ ] **Give the final go-ahead to submit for review** — A "yes"
  Claude will not submit without your explicit yes.

## 5. Decisions only you can make

Claude's recommendation is in brackets.

- [ ] **The "Open the free web app" buttons** — A decision
  The live site has several, and they lead to a "not open yet" page. [Relabel them "Web app coming soon" until it opens.]

- [ ] **When and where the free web app opens**
  After the price-data question. It needs a host with Node 24 and a disk (Fly.io, Render, Railway or a small VPS, ~$5-10 a month). [app.cartworth.app: it cannot sit under cartworth.app/app/ without rework.]

- [ ] **The iPhone search radius**
  The phone keeps stores out to 1.6x the radius you pick (18 mi on a 10-mile setting); the website is strict. [Make the phone match the website.]

- [ ] **Pages for search traffic**
  The site is four pages, too thin to rank for anything but the name. City and store pages ("cheapest groceries in Milwaukee") would change that. [Yes, after launch.]

- [ ] **"More than seventy chains" on the site**
  The real number is 94 chains with prices out of 119 in the catalog. Understating is the safe side. [Say 90+.]

- [ ] **A weekly automatic wrong-price sweep**
  Retailers change their data without warning; this round found three new kinds of wrong price. [Yes, as a scheduled task, one ZIP per day so Instacart is never pressed.]

- [ ] **The daily price tracker** — A decision
  Built and not switched on. It runs 2 to 2.8 hours a day on your Mac, at the same one-request-at-a-time pace as the app, and writes about 3 GB a year to Google Drive. Installing it is one command (see ops/launchd). [Yes, if the Mac is usually on overnight.]

## 6. Around Thanksgiving

- [ ] **Nov 16 to 20: say "go" on a second Thanksgiving test** — A "go"
  Today no store has turkey deals or fresh cranberries in stock, so the most important check (that a genuinely cheap 37 cents/lb turkey is not flagged as an error) could only be simulated. Thanksgiving is Thursday, November 26.

- [ ] **Test on real devices** — 1 hour
  Your iPhone, and an iPad if possible. The simulator cannot show the iPhone Duo's inner screen at all.